

Bluff

YOUR WAY THROUGH

Networking

Every device you buy today boasts of one or more ways to network it. However, not all of us are as comfortable with networking terms. We hope this will help...

CAT: CAT5/CAT6 are fifth and sixth generation Ethernet twisted pair cable standards defined by the Electronics Industries Association and Telecommunications Industry Association (EIA/TIA). CAT has nothing to do with felines.

Usage: Someone brought a cat to the office, but unfortunately the cat had a liking for CAT cables. Now we're planning on implementing a WLAN!

Network Address: A network address is a unique identifier for a computer on a network. Computers determine the addresses of other computers on the network and then use these to send messages to each other. An example of a network address is the Internet Protocol (IP) address, or the Media Access Control (MAC) address.

IP: An IP address uniquely identifies computers on a network. It can be private, for use on a LAN, or public, for use on the Internet. IP addresses can be assigned as static IPs (by a system administrator) or dynamic IPs (on demand, automatically, by another device on the network).

MAC: Device manufacturers permanently burn a Media Access Control (MAC) identification into networking devices, so that they can be identified easily. Using a MAC address authentication, computers can ensure that they connect to the right destination everytime, preventing fake devices from claiming to be the destination for data.

Usage: There was a hack attempt recently, some guy got hold of a networked IP address on our WLAN. He then used that address to spoof himself and identify with the WLAN and started deleting files at random. Chaos ensued, but our systems engineer used a lookup to find his MAC address, which we then traced to his internet IP address. His current address is jail!

Move Over

Wise men over the years have said, "Change is the only constant". We couldn't agree more. Living in the technology world, we have to embrace the changes that come about at a rapid pace and a big change is currently taking place in Team Digit. As we bid goodbye to our executive editor Sachin Kalbag with a heavy heart, it is time to welcome the new Ed, Deepak Ajwani. "It's been a great ride, but as I had said in my last month's editorial- 'Yahan Par Hamarai Kahani offbeat ho jaati hai, this is where we part ways,'" said Sachin. So, as Deepak finds his feet in the Digit-al world, let's give him a warm welcome, shall we?

Speaking of changes, there are some more that have been made to this issues'

DVD and CD. They both carry unique content now and will also no longer need a browser to install. Yes, we said it earlier too, "change is the only constant". A lot of time and energy was spent debating ways to improve the DVD/CD combo further and the results are there for all to see. Kudos to Robert and Ishan who have successfully implemented it (and as usual, in a tight timeframe). Be sure to let us know how you like it.

This month was also a 'sick' month given that three team members were down and out of action for a while. Changes in weather and the seemingly never-ending wait for the elusive monsoon finally took a

toll. It could also have been all the 4th anniversary celebrations that happened, you know!

DIGIT DIARY



TOUGH NEW LAW

Sweden Bans Net Downloads

In the first such move that we've heard of, Sweden's Parliament has passed a law that will make it illegal to download copyrighted material from the Internet, effective July 1, and has approved measures to discourage people from burning copies of CDs and DVDs. The law also outlaws technology and software used to circumvent copy protections on copyrighted material, including music, movies and games.

Members of the Parliament argued the usual way—that musicians and film-makers, for example, have the right to receive proper payment for their work.

It happens that Sweden has been plagued by one of the highest rates of piracy in the world, according to industry officials. Until now, it was only prohibited to make copyrighted material available for others to download, while it was legal to download it yourself. The

scope of the new law doesn't end there: it also makes it illegal to copy an entire book in a copying machine, including textbooks in schools.

So how will the law 'discourage' people from burning CDs and DVDs? There's been a tax slapped on recordable CD and DVD-discs. Consumers will have to pay an extra tax of 1.75 kronor (Rs 10) for a 700 MB disk. Also, the price of a 5 GB DVD is expected to rise from 10 kronor (Rs 60) to 30 kronor (Rs 180).

An interesting aside to all this is that a huge Swedish torrent site, The Pirate Bay, already has a message on the main page of the site saying "By the way, we will NOT shut down on the 1st of July."

